



TIPS & TRICKS

Parentheses matching, using '%' in the Vi or Vim editor

 Here is a tip that can be very useful for programmers writing or debugging code in C language, using the Vi or Vim editor. This will help you to find the opening and corresponding closing parentheses/bracket.

When working in 'Command' mode in the Vi editor, '%' can be used to find the opening/closing parentheses/bracket corresponding to its closing/opening parentheses/bracket, which is currently under the cursor. That is, if a simple C program is opened, and you press '%' in command mode when the cursor is under the last closing parentheses/bracket '}', the cursor will move to the opening parentheses for the main function. Similarly, you can find if there exists a closing parentheses/bracket for all opening parentheses in your code.

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Enjoy Linux commands

 Given below are a few one-line commands for you to try out to experience the power of Linux.

1. Here is a quick one-line command to generate a random password from the Linux command line.

```
# < /dev/urandom tr -dc _A-Z-a-z-0-9 | head -c6
```

The above command will generate a random string of six characters. The string can be used as an auto-generated password. The number of characters of the string can be increased by increasing the character count in the head command. In the above command, the character count is given as '6'.

1. Shown below is a command that will allow you to run a command, repeatedly, and display the output.

Using this you can watch the program output change over time. By default, the program runs the command every 2 seconds. You can set the time interval by using the '-n' option.

```
watch -d ls -l
```

The above command will watch the current directory for any file change and highlight the change when it occurs.

2. Using the 'touch' command, you can set the 'Time Stamp' of any file.

```
touch -c -t 0001010800 filename.c
```

After running the above command, the time stamp for 'filename.c' will be displayed, which in the above example is '2008-01-01 8:00', where the format is: 'YYMMDDhhmm'.

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Change the priority of an already running process

 Typically, the kernel of a system decides how much processor time is required for a process, based on the nice value. The possible nice value range is: -20 to 20, where a process that has a nice value of -20 denotes that it is of a very high priority. Likewise, the process that has a nice value of 19 is of very low priority.

For example:

```
# ps axl | grep named
```

```
0    0 9098 8733 18    0 61164    736 pipe_w S+   pts/1  
0:00 grep named
```

In the above output, the sixth column with value 0 is